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A People of the Frontier: An Account of the Āyromlu Tribe between the Qajar, Ottoman, and Russian Empires

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Abstract

This article offers a translation of the unpublished short historical chronicle of the Āyromlu tribe, a ten-folio manuscript located in the British Library. Entitled *Ketābcha-ye tāyefa-ye Āyromlu* (The Booklet of the Āyromlu Tribe), it was composed in 1886/1304 in the northwestern borderlands of Qajar Iran by one Mohammad b. Bahrām Khān Āyromlu. Although principally motivated by the author's desire to obtain salaries and lands that had been taken away from his family by its rivals, the text recounts the fascinating history of the Āyromlu over the course of the Safavid, Afshar, and Qajar eras. Drawing on oral and written sources, the author offers us a picture of tribal life and politics in the Caucasian imperial borderlands between the Ottoman, Iranian, and Russian states.

Keywords

Āyromlu tribe – Qajar Iran – borderlands – bureaucracy – Ottoman-Iranian conflict – Caucasus

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Introduction

British Library manuscript Or. 5428, entitled *Ketābcha-ye tāyefa-ye Āyromlu* (The Small Book of the Āyromlu Tribe), is a short Persian-language chronicle recounting the history of the Āyromlu, a Turkish tribe residing in the Iranian-Ottoman borderlands during the last few centuries. The colophone bears the date 11 November 1886/13 Safar 1304 and identifies its author as Mohammad b. Bahrām Khān Āyromlu. Accordingly, the text is concerned primarily with the Qajar period (*r.* 1789–1925) which had begun roughly a century prior to its writing, although we also find some interesting anecdotes regarding the Timurid, Safavid, and Afsharid eras. The author states that the contents derive primarily from "the judgment of historical chronicles and the accounts of the Ayrumlu elders," suggesting that he consulted written sources but also drew extensively on oral accounts and historical memory.

The account was penned for a rather peculiar reason which the reader comes to realize only in its final pages: it is in fact an appeal for the redress of economic grievances: "These days, Avajiq [the region then inhabited by the Āyromlu] has fallen on extremely hard times," the author laments, and "As many as fifty of the chieftains (*āqā*s) of Avajiq have no state salary, and they serve without compensation" (8v). Apparently, the tribe had been overlooked in state records and the author was following the advice of a Qajar official to seek recourse by writing a brief history containing the names and titles of the Āyromlu cavalry. The specific objective was to secure salaries via economic rights to state land-grants (*toyul*) for the fighters whose income had come to be usurped by their local rivals.

This manuscript constitutes the last link in a lengthy chain of attempts to resolve this issue of Āyromlu land and salary claims. Luckily, Mohammad Khān took care to include a transcription of several exchanges via telegraph from the preceding years between Pāshā Khān, the leader of the Āyromlu at the time of the chronicle's composition, and three different high-level Qajar officials. These exchanges, highlighting the exhaustive nature of the tribe's efforts to navigate nineteenth-century Iranian bureaucracy, appear as an appendix on the final folio of the manuscript and demonstrate a direct line of correspondence between Pāshā Khān and central figures of Qajar rule, even including Moshir al-Dowla (Mirzā Hoseyn Khān, 1828–81), the Qajar grand vizier from 1871 to 1873. Mohammad Khan's account, then, is a continuation of previous Āyromlu appeals for justice, highlighting the grievances of his own family, which had ruled previously the tribe for generations before Pāshā Khān became its leader in the 1860s.

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The textured and local history described in the rest of the text, though, will be of equal interest to most readers. Much of the account is devoted to recounting the tribe's long history of migration and forced displacements. The author states that the Āyromlu were part of the Rumlu tribe who were a key part of the Safavid coalition, and that the prefix "*āy-*" was added to their name at some point in time. This assertion fits with the identification of the Buzuq region in central Anatolia as the tribe's historic homeland, as this area was also the historic home of the Rumlu before they joined the Safavid coalition in the late fifteenth century—although the description of Buzuq as part of Greater Syria (*Shāmāt*), is intriguing and somewhat perplexing. The story may be more complicated, however, as some of the specific Āyromlu factions listed in the account—such as the Bāyanderlu, described as the leading tribe of the Āyromlu since the time of Timur (2r), the Amirlu, and the Qārāmānlu—suggest that elements of the disbanded Aq Qoyunlu coalition may have also later been incorporated into the Āyromlu fold (Woods, 11–15, 184, 195).

The Āyromlu resided along the northwestern Iranian frontier during the Safavid and early Qajar periods, but nineteenth-century Russian encroachments into the Caucasus eventually pushed them out of their tribal territory in Shura-Gel (present-day Gyumri in modern Armenia). What followed was a long series of peregrinations along the Ottoman-Iranian frontier beginning in the Ottoman city of Kars and then passing through the environs of Urmia and an autonomous Kurdish emirate at Rawandiz. Eventually, the tribe settled in the vicinity of Avajiq, which lies just south of Mount Ararat.

In 1838, the French traveler and anthropologist Arthur de Gobineau (1816–82) described the "Ayramlous" as beneficiaries of this frontier position:

> These courageous men are professional frontier-guardsmen, but they know how to adapt to many trades. Since the Turkish, Russian, and Persian borders meet in their proximity, certain men from all three lands (provinces) have forged for themselves an impunity quite difficult to curb. On Persian territory, the Turks are held responsible for all of the ills that take place. In the other countries, it is the fault of the Ayramlous.
>
> (DE GOBINEAU, II, 266)[1]

They were, in other words, an archetypal borderland community who reaped the benefits of their frontier position in order to govern themselves "without external interference" (3v), as well as to enjoy special benefits as the opportunity

1 Unless otherwise noted, all translations are our own.

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arose. Indeed, the author of our manuscript recounts how the much-lionized *sar-tip*[2] Pāshā Khān was given special permission by the Qajar authorities to wear an Ottoman medal of honor, given to him for sheltering Ottoman families during a Russian invasion (9r).

It is nonetheless interesting to see how well-integrated the Āyromlu were in the Qajar state apparatus despite their extreme frontier position. While it is possible that the official status of the tribal cavalry was over-emphasized in an effort to portray them as loyal servants of the state, the author of the text appears eager to highlight the military-administrative rank of the tribal khans at every opportunity. The narrative is driven by political and military events, but it contains numerous anecdotes and will certainly be of interest to historians of the Caucasus as well as scholars eager to parse the mechanics of these imperial borderlands in the nineteenth century. Religious differences are scarcely alluded to, with the author reserving his fiercest criticisms for the khans of Maku—a frontier rivalry which could help us to better understand the social history of the region.

The manuscript is plain and unadorned, composed in a formal Persian register and containing numerous spelling errors, as parts were likely written with haste (see Fig. 1).

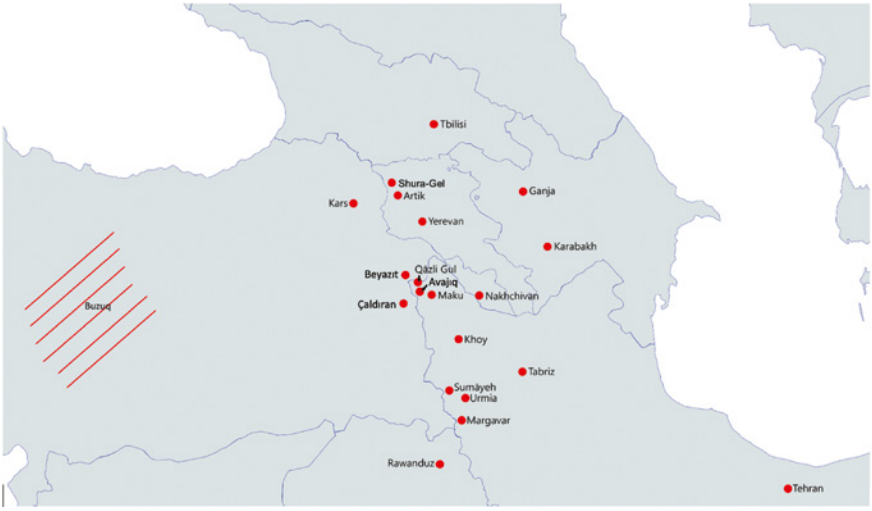


FIGURE 1 Map of eastern Anatolia, the southern Caucasus, and north-western Iran, with locations cited in the text

2 The title *sar-tip* translates roughly to "general" and indicates a senior military position within the Qajar military hierarchy.

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Translators' Note

An Oxford professor once remarked that there can never be translation, only a form of rendering. The spirit of his words was that texts written for audiences distant in both geography and time, rarely fit perfectly into the modern English language. Our text is undoubtedly subject to these limitations. While we have endeavored to fully capture its spirit, there have inevitably been moments where we have had to use our own modern interpretations to make the text relevant to the modern reader. In contentious cases, we have footnoted the text and of course accept that our reading is not the only one.

Though we adhere to *JPS* style in the transliteration of personal names and the presentation of names of localities, we have retained the use of the town and region of Shura-Gel, which has been known by a number of names over its history.[3] In this case we felt that adopting modern nomenclature would obscure the author's worldview and have left it in its original form. We have also generated a map with many of locations cited in the text (see Fig. 2).

For certain names and titles, we have maintained the original Persian terminology since the translation of titles such as *sar-dār* or *sar-tip* do not easily conform to the English "general" or "field marshal." We have also maintained *āqā* or khan, although these terms have entered modern Persian and English in ways unrepresentative of their use in the text. In other cases, simplification of a multiplicity of terms in the original text was dictated by readability: *il* and *tāyefa* have been merged to the problematic yet convenient "tribe," but at times also rendered when appropriate as "people" or "family." Several terms such as *nā'eb al-hokamā, leva*, and *farmān-farmā* have been translated using the English "governor," although each had a distinct and specific place in the Qajar hierarchy. The text refers to many individuals active in tribal or national affairs and, where possible, we have identified them using brackets or footnotes. A genealogy of the author, Mohammad b. Bahrām Khān Āyromlu, is also included for reference, as well as a chart showing the leadership of the tribe in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries (see Fig. 3 and Table 1).

For Persian transcription, we have maintained the original orthography of the manuscript along with its inconsistencies, occasional mistakes, and pre-modern forms. Only very few exceptions were made for the sake of

3 The town and region of Shura-Gel, sometimes spelled Shurehgel, Shurehgöl, or Shurehyel, is mentioned in the Treaty of Golestān (Elton). Under Imperial Russian rule, it was known as Alexandropol, during the Soviet era it was renamed Leninkan, and, since 1992, in the Republic of Armenia it is called Gyumri. Bournoutian notes (7, 11) that Shura-Gel is synonymous with the historic Armenian region of Shirak.

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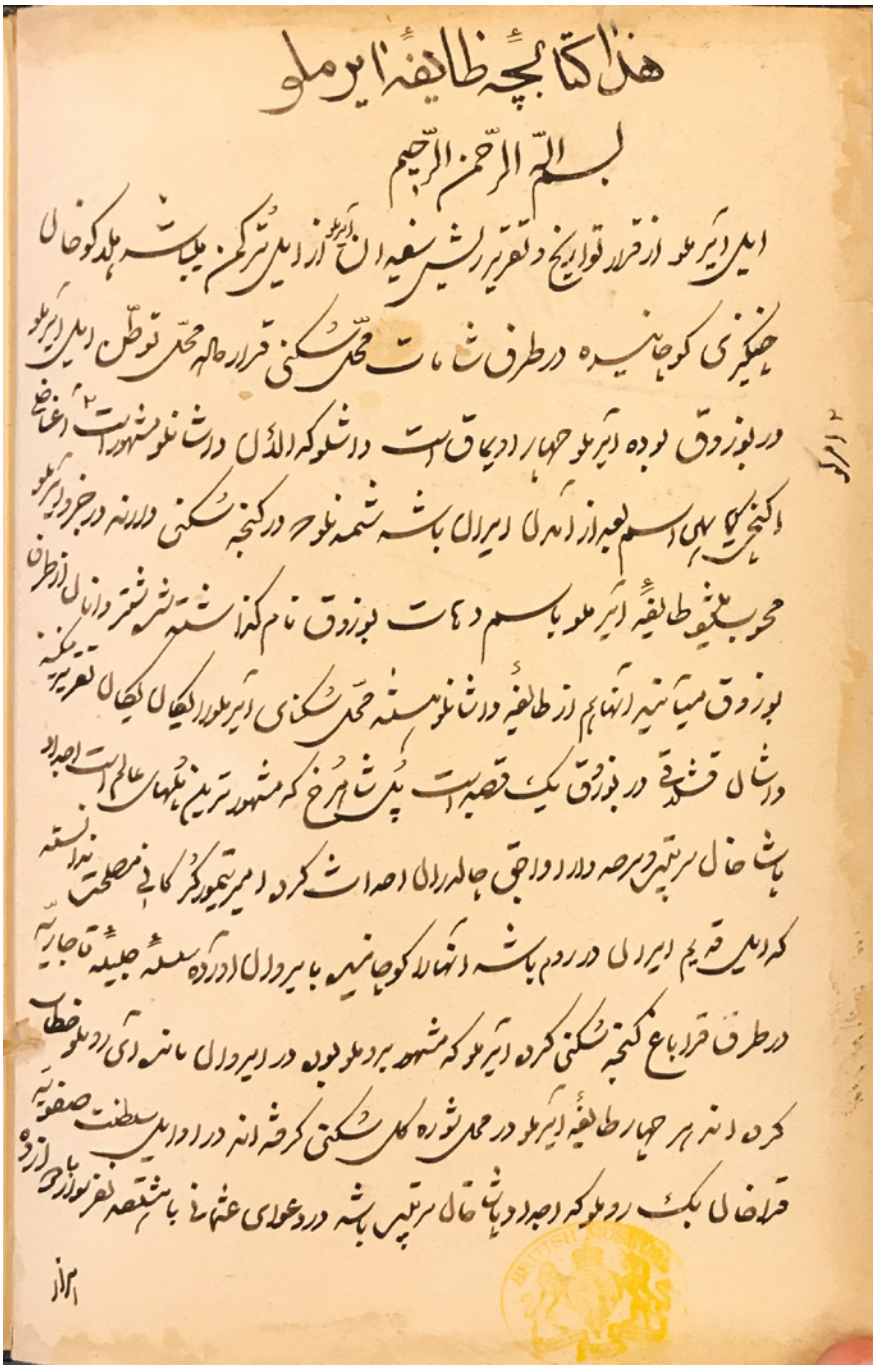


FIGURE 2 First folio of the manuscript
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clarity—such as rendering *kāf* (ک) as *gāf* (گ). We have added punctuation and divided the text into paragraphs to enable easier reading although both features are completely absent in the manuscript.

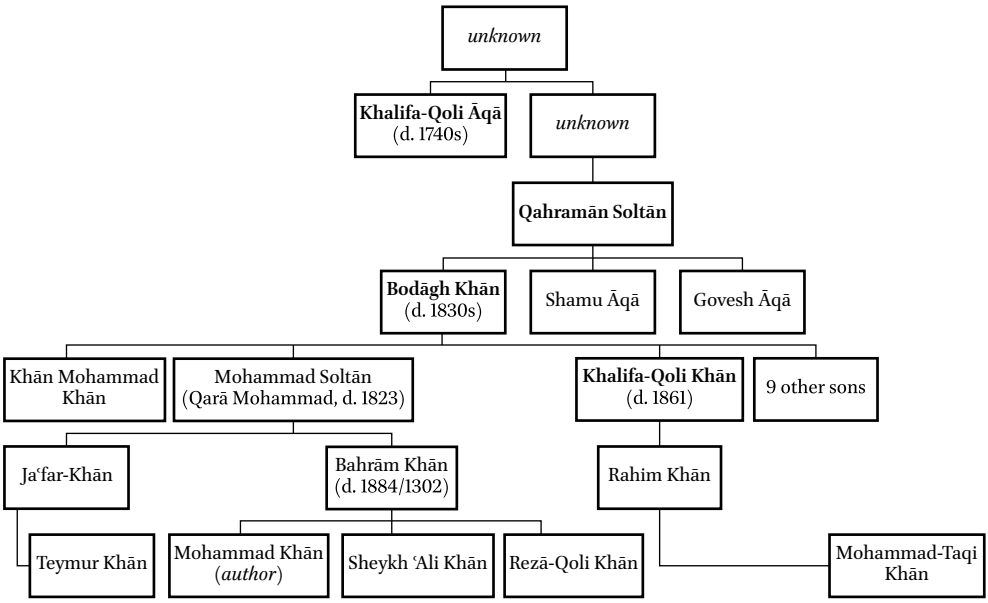


FIGURE 3 Genealogy of Mohammad b. Bahrām Khān Āyromlu, the text's author. Tribal leaders of the Āyromlu are in bold

TABLE 1 Leaders of the Āyromlu tribe (occasionally described in the text as leaders of its constituent clans, such as the Dāshānlu)

Leadership of the Āyromlu tribe	
1	Khalifa-Qoli Āqā (d. 1740s)
2	Qahramān Soltān
3	Bodāgh Khān b. Qahramān (d. 1830s)
4	Khalifa-Qoli Khān b. Bodāgh (d. 1861)
5	Pāshā Khān (made leader between 1861 and 1868)

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Ketābcha-ye tāyefa-ye Āyromlū (The Booklet of the Āyromlu Tribe)

English Translation	*Persian Original Text*
[IV]	
This is *Ketābcha-ye tāyefa-ye Āyromlū* (The Booklet of the Āyromlu Tribe).	هذا کتابچهء طایفهء آیرملو
In the name of God, the compassionate and the merciful.	بسم الله الرحمن الرحیم.
According to the judgment of historical chronicles and the accounts of the Āyromlu elders, the Āyromlu tribe is of the Turkman people. The Chengizid Hülegü Khān relocated them and had them reside in Greater Syria (*Shāmāt*);[4] the settlement area of the Āyromlu was in Buzuq.[5] The Āyromlu are four clans (*uymāq*): the Dāshlu, who are now known as the Dāshānlu;[6] the Āghāzli; the Akanchi (supposedly, this is their name after coming to Iran); and the Shamdanlu, who reside in Ganja and are considered to be part of the Āyromlu. The Āyromlu tribe is called by the names of the villages of Buzuq. The Shotorvānān come from the area of Buzuq and they, too, are from the Dāshānlu tribe. They [*i.e.*, the Āyromlu elders] refer to each of the places of residence of the Āyromlu. Dāshān, which is a winter pasture (*qeshlāq*) in Buzuq, is [also] a village (*qasba*). The Shāhrokh Bridge,	ایل آیرملو از قرار تواریخ و تقریر ریش سفیدان آیرملو، از ایل ترکمن میباشد. هلاکو خان چنگیزی کوچانیده در طرف شامات محلّ سُکنی قرار داد. محلّ توطُّن ایل آیروملو در بوزوق بوده؛ آیرملو چهار اویماق است: داشلو که الآن داشانلو مشهور است؛* اغاضلی؛ اکنچی (گویا همین اسم بعد از آمدن ایران باشد)؛ شمدنلو که در گنجه سُکنی دارند در جزو آیرملو. محسوب میشود طایفهٔ آیرملو باسم دهات بوزوق نام گذاشته شده. شتروانان از طرف بوزوق میآیند،آنها هم از طایفهٔ داشانلو همیشه. محلّ سُکنای آیرملو را یگان یگان تقریر میکنند. داشان، قشلاق در بوزوق، یک قصبه است. پُل شاهرُخ،
Amirlu.	*امرلو.

4 The term used here for Syria, *Shāmāt*, was wide-reaching and could include swathes of modern Turkey and Iraq.

5 Buzuq was a region of central Anatolia stretching from Yozgat perhaps as far east as Malatya. It was later the name of an Ottoman province in roughly the same area.

6 (*) Author's note in the margin.

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which is the most renowned of the bridges of the world, was built by the ancestors of the *sar-tip* (general) and guardian of the frontier (*sarhad-dār*) of the Avajiq-Çaldıran (Chālderān) area, Pāshā Khān.[7]

که مشهورترین پُلهای عالم است، اجداد پاشا خان سرتیپ و سرحددار اواجق چالدران احداث کرده.

Amir Timur Gorgān[8] did not think it expedient that an ancient Iranian tribe be in the lands of Rum,[9] and he forced them to migrate and brought them to Yerevan. The noble Qajar family settled in the vicinity of Karabakh and Ganja. The Āyromlu, who used to be known as the Rumlu, remained in Yerevan and came to be called the Āyromlu. All four clans of the Āyromlu took up residence in the area of Shura-Gel.

امیر تیمور گُرگانی مصلحت ندانسته که ایل قدیم ایران در روم باشد، آنها را کوچانیده بایروان آورده. سلسلهء جلیلهء قاجاریّه در طرف قراباغ گنجه سُکنی کرده. آیرملو، که مشهور برواملو بوده،در ایروان مانده آی روملو خطاب کرده اند. هر چهار طایفه آیرملو در محل شوره گل سُکنی گرفته اند.

In the early years of the Safavid Sultanate, Qarā Khān Bek Rumlu, who is a forebear of *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, fought in the Ottoman wars with eight hundred horsemen

در اوایل سلطنت صفویّه،قراخان بک روملو، که اجداد پاشا خان سرتیپ باشد،در دعوای عثمانی با هشتصد نفر سوار با دوازده هزار

[2r]

against an Ottoman army of twelve-thousand and inflicted a decisive defeat.

هزار قشون عثمانی دعوا کرد و شکست فاحش داد.

As the author of the *Rowzat al-safā* (Garden of Purity)[10] documented

چنانچه صاحب « روضة الصّفا »

7 Pāshā Khān represents the family line that ruled over the Āyromlu at the time of the text's composition.

8 The term *gorgān* means "son-in-law" in Mongolian and was used by Timur (*r.* 1370–1405) in an attempt to link himself to Chengiz Khān (*r.* 1206–27).

9 This term refers to former Byzantine ("Roman") lands, roughly corresponding to modern Anatolia and later coming to be equated with Ottoman territory. This sentence references the large-scale forced migrations under Timur that brought Turkish-speaking tribes back into Iran from Anatolia.

10 The *Rowzat al-safā* was a classic work of universal history composed in 1497 by Mohammad b. Borhān al-Din Khᵛāndshāh (known as Mir-Khᵛānd, 1433–98) and later continued by Rezā-Qoli Hedāyat (1800–71) in 1857. It is apparently to this later recension, known as the *Rowzat al-safā-ye Nāseri* (The Nāseri Garden of Purity), that the text refers.

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در احوالات صفویّه مفصلاً نوشته، داشانلو در میان طایفهٔ آیرملو برشادتی مشهور[است]. آن دو طایفه را، که امرلو و اغاضلو باشد، از شوره گل با ضرب شمشیر بیرون کرده خودشان صاحب شده اند. اکنچی هم، در جزو داشانلو. باجداد پاشا خان سرتیپ اطاعت داشته. داشانلو هم چهار طایفه است؛ طایفهٔ پاشا خان سرتیپ، که از عهد امیر تیمور گُرگان آتا و رئیس طایفهٔ آیرملوست. بایندرلو میگویند، به طایفهٔ اعلیحضرت اقدس شاهنشاهی روحنا و روح العالمین فداه ملحق میشود. از قرار تقریر اهالی بوزوق، بایندر یک قصبه و محل است. در طرف بوزوق و سه طایفهء دیگر هم: قرامانلو، و قیاپه، عَبدالی. هر چهار طایفه به اجداد پاشا خان سرتیپ اطاعت داشته.

in detail concerning the Safavids, among the tribes of the Āyromlu the Dāshānlu are most renowned for their bravery. [They] forced two tribes, the Amirlu and the Aghāzlu, out of Shura-Gel by the sword and took possession of it for themselves. From among the Dāshānlu, the Akanchi also submitted to the ancestors of the *sar-tip*Pāshā Khān. The Dāshānlu are also [composed of] four tribes; [there is] the tribe of the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, which, from the time of Amir Timur Gorgān has been the chief and leader of the Āyromlu. It is called the Bāyanderlu, and they joined the tribe of his most holy royal majesty to whom we all owe our eternal devotion (*ruhenā va ruh al-ʿālemin fadāʾoho*).[11] According to accounts from the inhabitants of Buzuq, Bāyander is a small town (and its environs) in the vicinity of Buzuq. There are also three other tribes [in the Dāshānlu]: the Qarāmānlu, the Qiyāpah, [and] the ʿAbdali. All four of these tribes submitted to the ancestors of the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān.

بموجب فرمان پادشاهان صفویّه، که آرپالوق داده، و قباله که در دست است، محلی شوره گل سیصد پارچه دیه است. چند دهی هست که هشتصد و هفتصد خانوار ارمنی زرافشان میشود. در عهد

According to the decree of the Safavid kings, who gave it as a land grant (*ārpāluq*), and the deed that we have in hand, the area of Shura-Gel has three hundred villages (*dih*). There are a few villages which consist of seven or eight hundred families of Armenian goldsmiths. In the time of

11 This stock phrase is used throughout the text whenever reference is made to the Qajar sovereign.

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the late Shāh ʿAbbās [I, *r.* 1588–1629], may he rest in eternal peace, the inhabitants of Yerevan submitted a complaint about the Dāshānlu tribe. Shāh ʿAbbās went and besieged the Dāshānlu for three days. There was a fortified church in Artik considered part of Nārin Qalʿa which the shah destroyed by cannonball, killing and plundering the Dāshānlu. For some time, Shura-Gel remained in ruins.[12] Later, the Dāshānlu rebuilt the town.

شاه عبّاس، ماضی طیّب الله تربته، اهالی ایروان از دست ایفهٔ داشانلو شکایت کرده اند. شاه عبّاس رفته داشانلو را سه روز محاصره کرده. یک کلیسای محکم در ارتیک بوده به نارین قلعه محسوب میشود شاه با توب خراب کرده. طایفهٔ داشانلو را قتل غارت کرده شوره گل چند وقتی خراب میماند* بعد طایفهٔ داشانلو دوباره آباد میکند.

In the time of Nāder Shāh Afshār [*r.* 1736–47], Khalifa-Qoli Āqā—who is an ancestor of Khalifa Khān the guardian of the frontier of Avajiq

در عهد نادر شاه افشار، خلیفه قلی آقا—که اجداد خلیفه خان سرحددار اواجق است،

[2v]

and who was named after him—was the leader (*āqā*) of the Āyromlu and Dāshānlu tribe. When Nāder Shāh's army was in Nakhchivan, the sovereign's guards went to Shura-Gel to procure rations. Khalifa-Qoli Āqā had the guards beaten and then cut off their ears and blinded them. Nāder Shāh had his army seize Khalifa-Qoli and his sons, including Nehān Āqā and others, and had them brought before him in shackles. He said, "Ingrate, whence did you summon the courage to send me the royal guards with their eyes gouged out and ears cut off?"

Khalifa-Qoli Āqā dared to say, "The ingrate is he who betrayed the throne and the crown of the Safavid sultans!"

که نام او را باین گذاشته اند در شوره گل—در میان طایفهٔ آیرملو و داشانلو آقا بوده. اوردوی نادر شاه افشار که در نخچوان بوده، محصلهای نادر شاه رفته اند شوره گل سیورسات بیاورند. خلیفه قلی آقا محصلهای نادر شاه را، بعد از کوتک کاری قطع گوش و بینی کرده. نادر شاه قشون مأمور کرده خلیفهٔ قلی آقا را با پسرانش، نهان آقا و غیره، گرفته مغلولاً بحضور نادر شاه برده. حضورًا فرمایش کرده « نمک بحرام جسارت بکجا رسانیده اید که محصلهای اینجانب را قطع بینی و گوش کرده نزد من میفرستی ؟ »

خلیفه قلی آقا جسارت کرده گفت « نمک بحرام همان آدم است که به تخت و تاج سلاطین صفویّه خیانت کرده !»

It is documented in the *Rowzat al-safā*.

* در « روضت الصّفا » مسطور است.

12 (*) Author's note in the margin.

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همان ساعت حکم کرده خلیفه قلی آقا را با پسرانش باغ کرده اند.

That very hour [Nāder Shāh] had Khalifa-Qoli Āqā and his sons executed.

بعد از کشته شدن خلیفه قلی آقا چند وقتی حکومت شوری گل و طایفهٔ داشانلو از دست اینها رفته. بعد قهرمان سلطان برادرزادهٔ خلیفه قلی آقای مقتول آقا گری داشانلو را تصاحب شده. رشد آقای بیکی در آن اوان که در میان طایفهٔ اکراد در رشادت مشهور بوده. قهرمان سلطان رشد آقا را کشته بعد از آن مشارالیه بسیار نام آور مشهور گردیده. در حیات خودش بداغ خان پسر بزرگ خود را که عاقل و رشید از همه اولاد بوده از آقا محمد شاه مرحوم طاب ثراه خلعت و فرمان آورده در شوره گل در میان طایفهٔ داشانلو آقا نموده.

After the killing of Khalifa-Qoli Āqā, for some time they [*i.e.*, the family] lost control of Shura-Gel and the leadership of the Dāshānlu tribe. Later, Qahramān Soltān, the nephew of the murdered Khalifa-Qoli, claimed leadership (*āqāgari*) of the Dāshānlu. One Roshd Āqā was at that time a chief (*beyg*) famed among the Kurdish people for his bravery. Qahramān Soltān killed Roshd Āqā and afterwards the former gained great renown. During his life, his own oldest son Bodāgh Khān, the cleverest and the bravest of his sons, received a robe of honor and a decree (*khalʿat va farmān*)[13] from Āqā Mohammad Shāh [*r.* 1789–97], may he rest in peace, and was made *āqā* of the Dāshānlu clan in Shura-Gel.

محمد خان قاجار حاکم ایروان به خاقان

Mohammad Khān Qājār, the ruler of Yerevan,

[3r]

طاب ثراه یاقی و سرکش کرده. بداغ خان معزّالیه را خبط دماق دیده بداغ خان از محمّد خان کناره جو گشته تمکین نکرده. محمد خان ده هزار قشون بامر کرد که کلبعلی خان نخچوانی کور که همه وقت خاین دولت هستند

rebelled against the *khāqān* [*i.e.*, the Qajar shah], may he rest in peace. Bodāgh Khān saw that [Mohammad Khān] was out of his mind, so he opted to avoid him and refused to follow his orders. Mohammad Khān sent ten thousand soldiers to Shura-Gel under the leadership of Kalb-ʿAli Khān Nakhchevāni the Blind, who was an incessant traitor of the state

13 Accepting a robe in this manner would have signaled (or reinforced) that the Āyromlu accepted Qajar suzerainty, while the decree would have codified Bodāgh Khān's position of leadership in the area.

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(as it is recorded in the *Rowzat al-safā*, Ehsān Khān did not resist and let a fortress fall into the possession of the Russian army; he is the son of that very Kalb-ʿAli Khān!)

The Āyromlu stationed in Yerevan and the Qarāpāpāq came to the aid of Bodāgh Khān in tribal solidarity. The conflict between them dragged on for six months. Finally, Shamu Āqā and Govesh Āqā, the brothers of [Bodāgh Khān], were both killed by small cannon fire [*golula-ye zanburak*]. After their deaths, Bodāgh Khān marched on the encampment of Kalb-ʿAli Khān. According to the accounts of the elders, Bodāgh Khān had four hundred riflemen (*shamkhālchi*), defeated Kalb-ʿAli Khān and pushed him all the way to Yerevan. The casualties mounted among the armies of Yerevan and Nakhchivan. Then, Mohammad Khān had his seal put on a Qur'an and sent it to Bodāgh Khān to trick him into coming to Yerevan. Mohammad Khān seized him in his own house and imprisoned him. Several months later, the late *khāqān*, may he rest in peace,[14] made Pir-Qoli Khān a *sar-dār* (general) and sent him to Yerevan with an army, [where] he seized Mohammad Khān and fastened Bodāgh Khān's shackles upon Mohammad Khān's neck! He showed great favor to Bodāgh Khān and bestowed upon him four villages here listed, each with an income of

(چنانچه در «روضة الصّفا» مسطور است احسان خان دعوا نکرده قلعه را به تصرّف لشکر روس داد؛ پسر همان کلبعلی خان است!) بر شوره گل فرستاده. آیرملوهای مُتوقّف ایروان و قراپاپاق برای تعصّب ایلیّت به کومک براغ خان آمده. ششماه دعوای اینها امتداد یافته. در آخر شمو آقا و گِوُش آقا برادران مشارالیه بضرب گُلولهٔ زنبورک هر دو کشته شده اند. بعد از کشته شدن آنها بداغ خان به اوردوی کلبعلی خان یروش برده. از قرار تقریر ریش سفیدان بداغ خان چهارصد شمخالچی داشته کلبعلی خان را شکست داده تا به ایروان آورده. از قشون ایروان و نخجوان تلفیّات زیاد شده. بعد محمد خان قرآن مهر کرده فرستاده بداغ را فریفته به ایروان برده. محمد خان در خانهٔ خودش گرفته محبوس کرده. بعد از چند ماه خاقان مرحوم طاب ثراه پیرقلی خان را سردار کرده با قشون به ایروان فرستاده محمد خام را گرفته زنجیر بداغ خان را به گردن محمد خان زده! به بداغ خان التفات زیاد کرده چهار دیر که مداخل هر یکی

14 The text refers to the Qajar shah as the *khāqān*. In this instance, as we have been unable to deduce the exact period of these events, the reference appears to be either to the aforementioned Āqā Mohammad Shāh or Fath-ʿAli Shāh (*r.* 1797–1834).

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[3v]

one thousand *tomān*s and designated as *toyul* property by blessed decree: Pesar Pey; Qurdi-Qoli; Shahriyār; Farang.

هزار تمان میشود از قرار تفصیل ذیل ملکاً تیولاً بموجب فرمان مبارک به بداغ خان مرحمت فرموده: پسر پی؛ قوردی قلی؛ شهریار؛ فرنگ.

In the days of Bodāgh Khān's captivity, the Russian[s] arrived, took control of Shura-Gel, and claimed it for themselves. One year later, Bodāgh Khān went back to Shura-Gel. Mohammad Soltān, Bodāgh Khān's second son, was so brave and chivalrous that he was called Qarā Mohammad and became known by this name. The Russians took him to Tbilisi as a hostage and paid Mohammad Soltān a daily stipend of one Russian *tomān* (which is equal to three *tomān*s and five thousand *dināri* in Iran).

در ایّام محبوسی بداغ خان، روس آمده شوره گل تصرّف کرده تصاحب شده. بعد از یک سال بداغ خان دوباره به شوره گل رفته. محمّد سلطان پسر دوّیم بداغ خان که قرا محمد مشهور بوده از بسکه شجاع و دلیر بوده باین اسم نام گذاشته شده و مشهور گردیده. روس برسم گرو به تفلیس برده هر روز یکتمان روسی که سه تمان پنجهزار دینار ایران باشد به محمد سلطان خرج میداده.

They gave the region of Shura-Gel and the leadership of the Āyromlu to Bodāgh Khān, as in the previous years under Iranian rule when it was in his hands without any external interference. A notebook akin to a treaty, written and signed by the *sar-dār* and viceroy of the Caucasus (*jāneshin-e Qafqāz*), was given to Bodāgh Khān, and two other *sar-dār*s also signed and authenticated it. That very notebook is in our hands today.

و محل شوره گل را با آقاگری آیرملو مثل سنوات سابق که در عهد ایران در تصرّف بداغ خان بوده بدون مداخلهٔ غیر به معزّالیه میدهند. یک کتابچه که مثل قرارنامه است سردار و جانشین قفقاز نوشته قول کشیده به بداغ خان داده اند و دو سردار دیگر هم بعد از آن قول و صحّت کشیده اند. همان کتابچه الآن حاضر است.

Mohammad Soltān remained in Tbilisi for four years and fell in love with the daughter of Afkandpol,[15] who was of the nobles of Tbilisi and minister to the governors (*vāliyān*). She fell for him as well. The father and

محمد سلطان مدّت چهار سال در تفلیس میماند بعد بدختر افقندپل که از نُجبای تفلیس است و از وُزرای والیان است. عشق بهم رسانیده دختر هم همچون. پدر و

15 This name is unclear in the original manuscript. It appears to be a Georgian name rendered into Persian perhaps via Russian.

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مادر دختر محبوس کرده، به محمد سلطان نمیدهند که مسلمان است. دختر شب با محمد سلطان بطرف ایروان میآیند، حسین خان سردار ایروان التفات زیاد میکند. همان دختر گویا با جناب جلالتمآب

mother of the girl kept her hidden, refusing to give her to Mohammad Soltān because he was a Muslim. By night, the girl and Mohammad Soltān escaped to Yerevan where Hoseyn Khān, the *sar-dār* of Yerevan, showed great favor to them. That very girl is supposedly a cousin to the esteemed and illustrious

[4r]

جهانگیرخان و نریمان خان عموزاده است. و خان محمد خان برادر بزرگ محمّد سلطان که رشادت آن مشهور آفاق است از شوره گل آمده. حسین خان سردار چهار دهی که خاقان مرحوم به بداغ خان تیول مرحمت فرموده بود همان دهات را به خان محمد خان و محمد سلطان مرحمت فرموده و محل دوش را جا و مکان ایل قرار میدهد. خاقان مرحوم طاب ثراه با تصدیق سردار ایروان به خان محمد خان لقب خانی* و به محمّد سلطان منصب سرهنگ مرحمت میفرمایند، صاحب هفتصد نفر سوار و بیدق میشوند.

Jahāngir Khān and Nerimān Khān. Khān Mohammad Khān, the older brother of Mohammad Soltān (whose bravery was famed far and wide), arrived from Shura-Gel. Hoseyn Khān, the *sar-dār* of four villages which the former *khāqān* [Fath-ʿAli Shāh] had ordered be bestowed upon Bodāgh Khān as *toyul*, ordered that these same villages be given Khān Mohammad Khān and Mohammad Soltān and he chose the area of Dush as the primary territory for the tribe. With the confirmation of the *sar-dār* of Yerevan, the former *khāqān*, may he rest in peace, bestowed the title of khan[16] upon Khān Mohammad Khān and the rank of *sar-hang* (colonel) upon Mohammad Soltān, and they came to command seven hundred cavalry and infantry (*baydaq*).

* القاب خانی که به اعیان ایروان داده شده تا آنوقت متداول نه بود به خان محمد خان شوره گلی داده شده و منصب سرهنگی که به اعیان ایروان داده شده محمد خان سردار پدر خان بابا خان سردار و محمد سلطان داشانلو بوده در سنه ۸۲۲۱.

The title 'khan' that was given to the nobles of Yerevan was uncommon before that time. It was given to Khān Mohammad Khān of Shura-Gel and the rank of *sar-hang* was given to the Yerevan nobles in the year 1228 [1813]. The *sar-dār* Mohammad Khān was the father of the *sar-dār* Khān Bābā Khān and Mohammad Soltān Dāshānlu.

16 (*) Author's note in the margin.

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در دعوای روس خان محمّد خان یکصد سر نیزهٔ روس به ... سلطانیه فرستاده. در ایذاء این خدمات خاقان مرحوم طاب ثراه یک طاقه شال کشمیر و یک جفت تپانچهٔ اعلی و یک توپ زری با حامل عبّاس خان پیشخدمت خلعت فرستاده. الآن همان فرمان مبارک حاضر است.

In battle with the Russians, Khān Mohammad Khān sent one hundred Russian bayonets to the imperial [*illegible*]. For the trouble of this service, the late *khāqān*, may he rest in peace, sent a bundle of cashmere shawls and a pair of the finest pistols and a ball of silken thread with the porter of his retainer ʿAbbās Khān, [along with] a robe of honor. The same royal decree (*farmān-e mobārak*) is in our possession now.

در دعوای چپان اوغلی سردار عثمانی محمد سلطان با هزار سوار آیرملو و ذیلان در سرحد عثمانی قراول بوده. سلیمان آقای بیکس تازه از ایران طرح کرده به عثمانی رفته. داوطلب شده بطرف ایروان به اوردوی محمد سلطان شبیخون آورده. محمد سلطان را در چادر خودش سر بریده و پنجاه نفر هم از سوار محمد سلطان مقتول گردیده.

During the battle against the Ottoman *sar-dār* Chapān-oghlu, Mohammad Soltān kept watch over the Ottoman frontier with a thousand Āyromlu and Zilān cavalry. Suleyman, an undignified *āqā*, had recently schemed to leave Iran and join the Ottomans. He volunteered to go to Yerevan to launch a night ambush onto the encampment of Mohammad Soltān. [During the attack], he beheaded Mohammad Soltān in the latter's own tent and fifty soldiers from the army of Mohammad Soltān were also killed.

محمد سلطان دو پسر داشت: بهرام خان و جعفرقلی خان. بهرام خان شصت سال در طهران و شیراز و در هرات بدولت

Mohammad Soltān had two sons, Bahrām Khān and Jaʿfar-Qoli Khān. Bahrām Khān served and devoted himself for sixty years in Tehran, Shiraz, and Herat

[4v]

بدولت خدمت و جان نثاری نموده. دارای نشان و حمایل سرهنگی از درجه اوّل شدند دو سال قبل در سرحد اواجق تصدق فرق مبارک گردید.

to the service of the state. He acquired the insignia and sash of *sarhang* of the first rank. Two years ago [*c.* 1884/1302], on the frontier near Avajiq, he died [in your service].

نجفقلی سلطان خوئی مواجب اورا اشتباهًا در دفتر

Najaf-Qoli Soltān of Khoy wrongly recorded [Bahrām Khān's] salary

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under his own name in the official register [and wrote that] Bahrām Khān had no children. He has three sons—the oldest, Mohammad Khān, is salaried, and the insignia and sash of *sar-hang* belonging to the late Bahrām Khān were given to him by the authority of the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān.[17] [He has] two other sons, Sheykh ʿAli Khān and Rezā-Qoli Khān. By decree of the imperial world-sovereign, to whom eternal devotion is owed; and by an order via telegraph from his highness—the most glorious, loftiest father of Nāʾeb al-Saltana [Kāmrān Mirzā] Amir Kabir [1856–1929], and the minister of war,[18] to whom I am eternally devoted; and with the aid of the gracious, honorable, loftiest and most generous Moshir al-Dowla, the Minister of Foreign Affairs, may his great fortune endure, they showed [Bahrām Khān's] sons great favor.[19] May God sacrifice a life such as ours, that of a humble servant who is the most grateful in all of Iran, to the blessed imperial court (*āsetāna*), to which we owe lasting devotion.

باسم خود گذرانده که بهرام خان اولاد ندارد. بهرام خان سه پسر دارد—محمد خان پسر بزرگ بهرام خان صاحب مواجب است و نشان حمایل سرهنگی بهرام خان مرحوم بمشار الیه با تصدیق پاشا خان سرتیپ داده شده. دو پسر دیگر شیخعلی خان و رضاقلی خان. از قرار دستخط جهان مطاع شاهنشاهی روح العالمین فداه و حکم تلگرافی حضرت امجد ارفع والد آقای نایب السلطنه امیر کبیر و وزیر جنگ روحی فداه بتوسط جناب مستطاب اجلّ اکرم مشیرالدوله وزیر امور خارجه دام اقباله العالی به پسرانش مرحمت فرموده اند. خداوند جان مثل ما خانه زادان را قربان آستانهٔ مبارکه شاهنشاهی روحنا فداه فرماید که قدردان کل ایران است.

Let us return to the matter at hand: [how] relations between Iran and Russia were ruined. Bodāgh Khān

باز بیآیم بر سر مطلب فیمابین ایران و روس بهم خورده. بداغ خان

17 Mohammad Khān is the author of this text. We have been unable to identify Najaf-Qoli Soltān, but he appears to have been an adversary of the Āyromlu.

18 Here, Mohammad Khān is thanking obliquely the reigning Qajar monarch, Nāser al-Din Shāh (*r.* 1848–96), by mentioning his son Kāmrān Mirzā, who served among several roles as viceroy (*nāʾeb al-saltana*), minister of war (from 1869 to 1873, 1884, and 1896), and governor of Tehran and other provinces—but should not be confused with the earlier and more famous grand vizier Mirzā Taqi Khān Farāhānī (1807–52), known also as Amir Kabir.

19 A transcription of the telegraph correspondence between the Āyromlu, Amir Kabir, and Moshir al-Dowla appears in the appendix (fol. 10r).

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فرار کرده به ایروان آمده. هرچند صاحب روضة الصّفاء نوشته حسین خان و حسن خان با قوشون رفته محل شوره گل را تصرف کرده بداغ خان شوره گل را گرفته به ایروان آورده، سردار ایروان بجهت خدمات خودش برشتهٔ نظم کشیده. بداغ خان خودش آمده. نخچوان را احسان خان خاین دولت به تصرّف روس داده ایروان هم مفتوح روس گردید. طایفهٔ آیرملو بقدر چهار هزار خانوار بطرف قارص میرود زمستان را در قارص متوقف میشود. پسگوُج چندین دفعه به نزد بداغ آدم فرستاده مراجعت نموده « به ایروان بیاید کاغذ

fled and came to Yerevan. Although the author of *Rowzat al-safā* wrote that Hoseyn Khān [the *sar-dār* of Yerevan] and Hasan Khān went with an army and secured the area of Shura-Gel, captured Bodāgh Khān, and brought him to Yerevan, [in fact] the *sar-dār* of Yerevan [*i.e.*, Hoseyn Khān] recorded the events in this way to serve his own ends. [In truth], Bodāgh Khān came on his own. Ehsān Khān, the traitor to the state, gave Nakhchivan over to Russian control, and Yerevan was also conquered by the Russians. The Āyromlu tribe went to Kars with four thousand families to pass the winter. Paskevich[20] sent men to Bodāgh Khān several times, telling him repeatedly, "Come to Yerevan,

[5r]

میدهم محل شوره گل کما فی سابق در دست ایشان باشد .»

I will present you a document to restore Shura-Gel to you, as it was before."

بداغ از جمیع املاک خود دست کشیده نان نمک ولیهعد مغفور را فراموش و کفران نعمت نکرده. از راه اباقیه بطرق ارومی رفته، دیوان اعلی محل صومایه بره دوست را داده بقدر هشت سال در صومایه مشغول خدمت و جان نثاری کرده اند.

Bodāgh withdrew claims to all of his lands, [but] he was not guilty of ingratitude, nor did he forget the magnanimity of the late crown prince.[21] He went to Urmia via Abāqiyya, and the prime minister (*divān-e aʿlā*) granted him the district of Sumay-ye Beradust,[22] [where] he dedicated eight years to active service and self-sacrifice.

20 Ivan Fyodorovich Paskevich (1782–1856) was appointed the governor and military commander in the Russian Caucasus in 1827. He was responsible for capturing the khanates of Yerevan and Nakhchivan, which became part of the Russian Empire after the Treaty of Torkmānchāy (Turkmenchay) in 1828.

21 This likely refers to ʿAbbās Mirzā (1789–1833), the Qajar crown prince and governor of Azerbaijan after 1804.

22 This corresponds roughly to the sub-district located within the present-day county of Urmia in Iran, near the frontier with Turkey.

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The late Bodāgh Khān, in the time of the late *khāqān* [*i.e.*, shah], may he rest in peace,[23] received six hundred *tomān*s and 90 ass-loads of wheat as salary. Bodāgh Khān passed away in Sumaya.[24] The late crown prince bestowed the salary and the position of leadership of the tribe of the Āyromlu upon Khalifa-Qoli Khān, his older son. The Shekāk Kurds came and plundered several villages of the Āyromlu, carrying off all of their sheep and cattle. Khalifa-Qoli Khān went on the attack and took back the animals from the Kurds, and he decapitated Vaʿidollāh ʿAli, the uncle of ʿAli Khān Shekāk, along with six others and sent their heads to his highness Jahāngir Mirzā. The prince presented a robe of honor to Khalifa-Qoli Khān. Jahāngir Mirzā came to make the false claim that, in their hearts, the Āyromlu khans preferred the deputy to his highness, Mohammad Mirzā.[25] At the instigation of a pernicious group, Jahāngir Mirzā seized the Āyromlu khans and imprisoned them and the Āyromlu tribe fled to Kars and Yerevan. About four to five hundred households remained, whom he

بداغ خان مرحوم در عهد خاقان مرحوم طاب ثراه ششصد تمان نقد و نود خروار غلّه مواجب داشته. بداغ خان در صومایه وفات کرد،* ولیعهد مغفور مواجب و آقا گری ایل آیرملو را به خلیفه قلیخان پسر بزرگش مرحمت فرموده.

اکراد شکاک آمده چند پارچه دیه آیرملو را چاپیده هرچه اغنام و اموال داشته برده. خلیفه قلیخان به هوار رفته غنایم و اموال را از اکراد گرفته بر وعیدالله عموی علی خان شکاک را با شش نفر دیگر سر بریده به نوّاب جهانگیر میرزا فرستاده. شاه زاده خلعت انعام به خلیفه قلیخان مرحمت فرموده.

جهانگیر میرزا به ادّعای باطل افتاده خوانین آیرملو قلباً خرامان نوآب حضرت والد محمّد میرزا بودند. جهانگیر میرزا با تحریک مفسدین، خوانین آیرملو را گرفته محبوس کرده ایل آیرملو بطرف قارص و ایروان فرار کرده. بقدر چهارصد پانصد خانوار مانده آنها را

* بداغ خان دوازده پسر داشت اسامی آنها از قرار تفصیل است گر ذکر خواهم. خان محمد خان، محمد سلطان، خلیفه قلیخان، یار محمد آقا ، اسمعیل آقا، حضرت قلیخان، اسکندر خان سرهنگ، قهرمان خان، عزیز خان، حسین خان، رستم خان، جعفر خان.

Bodāgh Khān had twelve sons and their names will be mentioned here: Khān Mohammad Khān, Mohammad Soltān, Khalifa-Qoli Khān, Yār Mohammad Āqā, Esmāʿil Āqā, Hazrat-Qoli Khān, Eskandar Khān *sar-hang*, Qahramān Khān, ʿAziz Khān, Hoseyn Khān, Rostam Khān, Jaʿfar Khān.

23 This refers either to Fath-ʿAli Shāh or Mohammad Shāh (*r.* 1834–48).

24 (*) Author's note in the margin.

25 Most likely, Mohammad Mirzā is the crown prince at the time and future Mohammad Shāh (*r.* 1834–48).

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forcibly removed and sent to Urmia. He sent the tribe of the Ākhākhlu to Margavar.

هم کوچانیده به ارومی برده. طایفهٔ آخاخلو را بمرکور فرستاده.

He granted to Khalifah-Qoli Khān twenty villages as *toyul* along the Rawandiz River[26] and made this the area of residence for the tribe. The ruler (*mir*) of Rawandiz was not subject to the Ottoman state.[27] He massacred the army of Margavar

به خلیفه قلیخان خان در کنار نهر براندوز (**باراندوز**) بقدر بیست دِیه تیول و محلّ نشینی ایل قرار میدهد. میر رواندوز اطاعت به دولت عثمانی نداشته قشون مرکور را میر رواندوز

[5v]

and imprisoned the daughter of Esmāʿil Khān (the leader of the Ākhākhlu tribe) who was the betrothed of the *sar-hang* Eskandar Khān, along with Eskandar Khān and a few others, and brought them to Rawandiz.

قتل عام کرده دختر اسمعیل خان رئیس طایفهٔ آخاخلو که نامزد اسکندر خان سرهنگ بوده اسکندر خان را با چند نفر دیگر اسیر کرده به رواندوز برده.

From one side, the Ottomans mobilized an army; from the Iranian side, Navvāb Qahramān Mirzā, the governor (*farmān-farmā*) of Azerbaijan, arrived with a well-equipped army and got rid of the *mir* of Rawandiz. The Ottomans laid full claim to the territory of the *mir* of Rawandiz and brought defeat to the Ākhākhlu tribe.

از آن طرف عثمانی لشکر مامور میکند، از طرف ایران هم نوّاب قهرمان میرزا فرمان فرمای آذربایجان با لشکر مستعد میرود میر رونانوز را از میان برداشته. خاک تصرّف میر رواندوز را عثمانی تصاحب میشود خسارت طایفهٔ آخاخلو را عثمانی میدهد.

When the late Mohammad Shāh, may he rest in peace, marched upon Herat, Khalifa-Qoli Khān was a member of the royal entourage until it reached Shahrud. In Shahrud, [the shah] signed a document granting

مرحوم محمد شاه طاب ثراه بطرف هرات که یروش برده خلیفه قلیخان تا شاهروت ملتزم رکاب مبارک بوده. در شاهروت دستخط التفات فرموده

26 Spelled "Ravānduz" in the text, this likely corresponds to the location of the town of Rawandiz in the present-day Kurdish Autonomous Region (KRG) in northern Iraq. It is also the name of the valley in which the town is located and the river that runs through it. During the events described in the 1830s, it fell within the realm of the semi-autonomous Soran Emirate (*r.* 1816–36). Given that Jahāngir Mirzā had imprisoned some of the Āyromlu leaders, we can presume that this territory that he gave Khalifa-Qoli Khān was not considered choice land.

27 This refers to Mohammad Pāshā of Rawandiz (*r.* 1814–36), known in Kurdish as "Mirê Kor," who had carved out a semi-autonomous emirate in the region (Ateş, 67).

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Avajiq as *toyul* land to Khalifa-Qoli Khān. In the year 1254 [1838], [the latter] came to Avajiq, and ʿAli Khān Māku'i incited the Jalāli and the Zilān to fight daily with the Āyromlu so he might turn the desolated Avajiq into pasture and summer grazing lands for the Kurds. Thus far, fifty Āyromlu and Jalāli have been killed, and the Jalālis even killed the eldest son of Khalifa-Qoli Khān. In the year 1258 [1842], the drums of war were beaten between Iran and the Ottomans, and two thousand cavalry and infantry came to Avajiq. Khalifa-Qoli Khān fled Chāldirān and sought refuge there, in the very spot where the Safavid shah Esmāʿil [*r.* 1501–24], may he rest in eternal glory, and the Ottoman sultan Soleymān Khān[28] battled.

اواجق را ملکاً و تیولاً به خلیفه قلیخان داده. در سنه ۴۵۲۱ به اواجق آمده علی خان ماکوئی، جلالی ذیلان را تحریک کرده با آیرملوها هر روز دعوا کرده که شاید اواجق خراب مانده مرتع و ییلاق اکراد نماید. تا حال بقدر پنجاه نفر از آیرملو و جلالی کشته شده است حتّی پسر بزرگ خلیفه قلیخان را هم جلالی ها کشته. در سنه ۱۲۵۸ میان ایران و عثمانی نقاری واقع گشته بقدر دو هزار سوار و پیاده باواجق آمده. خلیفه قلی خان کوچ کرده در چالدران در همان مکان که شاه اسمعیل صفوی انار الله برهانهُ و سلطان سلیمان خان عثمانی دعوا کرده سقناق کرده اند.

[6r]

At daybreak, bullets hailed down upon Khalifa-Qoli Khān's tent, wounding him in his mouth. He bandaged it with a handkerchief, mounted his horse, and he pursued them (*i.e.*, the Ottoman troops) until he reached Gaduk Ulāq. He took back all of the sheep and loot which they had stolen and also killed ten of their number. He delivered [the news of] these victories to Bahman Mirzā, the prince of illustrious birth and the highest authority (*sāheb ekhtiyār*) in Azerbaijan,[29] who was in Chaman Dorosht [and who] sent a cloak of

در طلوع صبح چادر خلیفه قلیخان را گلوله باران کرده خلیفه قلیخان از دهنش زخم خورده. با دستمال بسته سوار شده در گدوک اولاق از عقب آنها رسیده. هر قدر کوسفند و غنایم که برده بودند از دست آنها کرفته بقدر ده نفر هم از آنها کُشته. این فتوحات را بعرض شاهزاده والا تبار بهمن میرزا صاحب اختیار آذربایجان که در چمن درشت بوده رسانیده، یک جبّه

28 The author mistakenly identifies Soleymān I (Süleyman I, *r.* 1520–66), rather than Selim I (*r.* 1512–20) as the Ottoman sultan who fought at the Battle of Çaldıran (1514).

29 Bahman Mirzā (1810–83/84) was the son of the crown price ʿAbbās Mirzā and governor of Azerbaijan from 1841 to 1847.

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fine silken cloth and one insignia of *sar-hang* of the first order to Khalifa-Qoli Khān in his honor.

ترمه و یک قطعه نشان سرهنگی از درجهٔ اوّل بافتخار مشار الیه فرستاده.

Among the two states there was peace and serenity and, once again, [Khalifa-Qoli Khān] returned to Avajiq. ʿAli Khān Māku'i held animosity towards [the Āyromlu] for two reasons. Firstly, if Avajiq were to be deserted, [its] pasture and summer grazing lands would pass to the tribes (*ilāt*) of Maku. Secondly, he was related to Kalb-ʿAli Khān Nakhchevāni [who also] bore enmity towards the Āyromlu. But by virtue of the protective shadow of imperial mercy, to whom we owe our eternal devotion, Khalifa-Qoli Khān never suffered defeat at the hands of that faction of the Maku khans.

فیما بین دولتین علیّتین سلم و صفا شده دوباره باواجق عودت میکند. علیخان مکوئی از دو جهت با آنها عداوت میکند. اوّلا اگر اواجق مخروبه باشد مرتع و ییلاق ایلات ماکو میشود. ثوانی با کلبعلی خان نخچوانی قوم هستند، با آیرملوها عداوت میکند. امّا که حمد از سایه مرحمت شاهنشاهی روحنا فداه هیچوقت خلیفه قلیخان با آن جزئی از خوانین ماکو شکست نخورده.

All of Iran in the time of the late shah was in a state of submission to them [*i.e.*, the Qajars]. Khalifa-Qoli Khān had not established his position until the late Mohammad Shah, may he rest in glory, had joined the sanctuary of divine mercy and his most holy royal majesty [*i.e.*, Nāser al-Din Shāh, *r.* 1848–96] installed himself upon the throne of his royal birthright. Day by day, Khalifa-Qoli Khān gained standing and power from the generosity of his most holy and rightly guided royal highness, to whom we are eternal devoted.

جمیع ایران در عهد شاه مرحوم در اطاعت ایشان بوده. خلیفه قلینال تمکین نکرده تا که مرحوم محمّد شاه طیّب اله تربته بجوار رحمت الهی پیوسته و اعلیحضرت اقدس شهریاری بر اریکهٔ سلطنت موروثی خود پا گذاشته و جلوس نموده. روز بروز خلیفه قلیخان از مرحمت اعلیحضرت اقدس همایون روحنا فداه ترقّی و قوّت گرفته.

[6v]

In the year 1277 [1860–61], ʿAbdollāh Beyg, the *motasarref* of the [Ottoman] sub-district (*levā*) of Bayazit came with two army regiments and five

در سنه ۱۲۷۷ عبد الله بگ متصرف لوای بایزید با دو فوج نظام و

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hundred army cavalry and five hundred Kurdish riders to Qebla Balāghi, which borders Avajiq and Qāzli Gol, and made camp—Qāzli Gol is supposedly Ottoman territory. The late Khalifa-Qoli Khān went to Avajiq with infantry and cavalry and set up camp directly across from them. They agreed to convey [the situation] to both states until an answer arrived for them to act upon. The late khan kept a small number of troops with himself and dismissed the rest of the cavalry and infantry troops.

پانصد سوارهٔ نظام و پانصد نفر سوارهٔ اکراد آمده در قبله بلاغی که سنور اواجق و قازلی گول است اوردو کرده—کویا قازلی گول خاک عثمانی است. خلیفه قلیخان مرحوم با سوار و پیادهٔ اواجق رفته در مقابل آنها اوردو کرده. قرار گذاشته اند به دولتین اعلام نمایند تا چه جواب برسد عمل نمایند.خان مرحوم یکقدر سوار و پیاده در نزد خودش نگّه میدارد ما باقی سوار و پیاده را مرخص میکند.

Suddenly, without warning, the Ottoman troops attacked from all sides and shelled Khalifa-Qoli Khān's reduced forces. A bullet struck ʿAli Soltān and he was killed, and several horses were struck as well. The rest of the cavalry mounted their horses with Khalifa-Qoli Khān and launched a counterattack. Tuzad Āqā, the leader of the Jelāli tribe, who possessed the rank of commander of one thousand troops (*minbāsh-gari*), was struck by a bullet, and the *sar-hang* Hemmat Khān, the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān's brother, fell and relinquished his soul in that very moment. A few others were killed as well.

یکدفعه علی الغفله عسکر عثمانی از هر طرف هجوم آور شده اوردوی جزئی خلیقه قلی خان را شنلیک کرده اند. به علی سلطان گلوله خورده مقتول شده و چند رئس اسب هم گلوله خورده. ما باقی سوار با خلیفه قلیخان سوار شده یک شنلیک میکنند. توزد آقا رئیس طایفهٔ جلالی که حامل نشان مین باش گری داشته با ضرب گلولهٔ همت خان سرهنگ برادر پاشا خان سرتیپ از اسب افتاده همان ساعت جان تسلیم کرده و چند نفر دیگر هم کشته شده.

The Ottomans were defeated, and Khalifa-Qoli Khān chased them all the way to Bayazit, but he prohibited that a single stake from their tents or any of their supplies be touched. He sent men, and others came from the Ottoman side, and they conveyed this situation to the guardians of the victorious state

عثمانی شکست خورده خلیفه قلیخان تا بایزید تعاقب کرده امّا خلیفه قلیخان قدغن کرده یک چوب از چادر و مخلفات آنها دست نزده. آدم فرستاده از عثمانی ها آدم آمده برده این کیفیّت را به امنای دولت قاهره

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and to the late commander-in-chief (*sepahsālār*), who was ambassador (*vazir-e mokhtār*) to Istanbul.[30] For the trouble of this service, the commander-in-chief himself had several gold watches and a bundle of cashmere shawls delivered [back to Khalifa-Qoli Khān] by these very messengers.

به سپه سالار مرحوم که در اسلامبول وزیر مختار بوده اعلام کرده. در ایذاء این خدمت خود سپه سالار یک عدد ساعت طلا و یک طاقه شال کشمیر ارسال فرموده بتوسط ایشان.

Ranks and distinctions were awarded by the state as detailed below:

از قرار تفصیل ذیل نشان و امتیازات دولت مرحمت شده:

- Khalifa-Qoli Khān, insignia of *sar-tip* with its sash;
- Pāshā Khān, insignia of *sar-hang* of the first rank with its sash;
- Hazrat-ʿAli Khān, insignia of a *sar-hang* of the first rank with its sash;

- خلیفه قلیخان نشان سرتیپ با حمایل ان؛
- پاشا حان نشان سرهنگ با حمایل آن از درجهٔ اوّل؛
- حضرت قلی خان نشان سرهنگ با حمایل ازدرجهٔ اوّل؛

[7r]

- Bahrām Khān, insignia of *sar-hang* with its sash, of the first class;
- Hemmat Khān, insignia of *sar-hang* with its sash, of the first class;
- Rezā Khān, insignia of *sar-hang*;
- Karim Khān, insignia of *sar-hang*;
- Rostam Khān, insignia of *sar-hang*;
- five pieces (*qatʿa*) of insignia of *yāvar*;[31]
- twenty pieces of gold and gilded (*talā va motallā*) insignia.

- بهرام خان نشان سرهنگ با حمایل آن از درجهٔ اوّل؛
- همت خان نشان سرهنگ با حمایل آن از درجهٔ اوّل؛
- رضا خان نشان سرهنگ؛
- کریم خان نشان سرهنگ؛
- رستم خان نشان سرهنگ؛
- نشان یاوری ۵ قطعه؛
- نشان طلا و مطلّا ۰۲ قطعه.

In the year 1278 [1861], one thousand families from the Āyromlu tribe came to Iran. Khalifa-Qoli Khān settled two hundred households of his

در سنه هزار دویست هفتاد هشت بقدر هزار خانوار از ایل آیرملو به ایران آمده. خلیفه قلیخان دویست خانوار از

30 The title *sepahsālār* was uncommon in the nineteenth century and only two Qajar officials received it. This passage refers to Mirzā Hoseyn Khān, who would later serve as grand vizier (1871–73) with the title Moshir al-Dowla.

31 This is a general military term meaning officer. Presumably, these insignia, along with the ones in the following line, were distributed to others (not named) who fought against the Ottomans.

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own people (*il*) and made Qāzli Gul habitable; it is now a town (*ābād*). Afterwards, the khans of Maku and Kalb-ʿAli Khān Nakhchevāni II, who were old foes of Khalifa-Qoli Khān, accused him of wrongdoing and took him to Tabriz to keep him in the service of the high *sar-dār* (*sar-dār-e kol*) ʿAziz Khān. He passed away there.

The guardians of the glorious state made the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān the commander of the frontier (*sarhad-dār*) in Avajiq.[32] In the year 1285 [1868], Hājji Mirzā Hoseyn Khān [Moshir al-Dowla], the great commander-in-chief (*sepahsālār-e aʿzam*), may he rest in peace, was arriving from Istanbul. On that very day and witnessed by the commander-in-chief, the Jalāli Kurds quarreled with the Āyromlu upon the instigation of the Maku khans. There were several casualties; Karim Khān, the brother of the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, was wounded and they destroyed Qāzli Gul, which the late Khalifah-Qoli Khān had taken such great pains to build. They carried off the plunder to the amount of twenty thousand *tomān*s from the Āyromlu inhabitants of Qāzli Gul. From that very plunder, the Maku khans gave seven thousand *tomān*s as a gift to the Servant of the State, the deputy of Azerbaijan (*moʾayyed*

ایل خودش کذاشته قازلی کول را آباد نموده الآن آباد است. بعد خلیفه قلیخان با تهمت خوانین ماکو با کلبعلی خان ثانی نخچوانی که هر دو دشمن قدیم خلیفه قلیخان هستند برده در تبریز در پیشکاری عزیز خان سردار کل نگاه داشته در تبریز وفات کرده.

امنای دولت قاهره پاشا خان سرتیپ را در اواجق سرحددار فرموده. حاجی میرزا حسین خان سپه سالار اعظم طاب ثراه که از اسلامبل میآمدند در سنه ۵۸۲۱. در همان روز در نظر سپه سالار اکراد جلالی با تحریک خوانین ماکو با آیرملو دعوا کرده. چند نفر تلفات شد: کریمخان برادر پاشا خان سرتیپ زخمدار گردید، قازلی گول را خراب کردند که خلیفه قلیخان مرحوم با چه زحمتها آباد کرده بود. بقدر بیست هزار تمان از آیرملوهای ساکن قازلی گول غنایم بردند. از همان غنیمت خوانین ماکو هفت هزار تمان به مؤیّد الدوله پیشکار آذربایجان پیشکش داده،

32 Pāshā Khān's specific ancestry in the Āyromlu tribe is not clear and he does not appear to have any direct relation to the family of Mohammad Khān, which figures prominently in this text.

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al-dowla pishkār-e Azarbāyjān),[33] and made Hazrat-Qoli Khān, the maternal uncle of the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, into their ally and into a claimant of [the titles and position of] the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān. Enmity came about among the sons of Bodāgh, and he forced the household of the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān and his *sar-dārs* to migrate from Avajiq. They made their winter quarters in Sokmanabad [near Khoy]. From Khoy, the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān dispatched Bahrām Khān [b. Mohammad Soltān], his cousin and his womb brother (*barādar-e batni*) to Tehran and he himself went to Tabriz.

حضرتقلی خان عموی پاشا خان سرتیپ را با خودشان متّفق کرده با پاشا خان سرتیپ مدعی. در میان اولاد بداغ نقار حاصل کردیده خانه پاشا خان سرتیپ و سردارانش را از اواجق کوچانیده. در سکمن آباد قشلاق کردند پاشا خان سرتیپ از خوی بهرام خان پسر عمو و برادر بطنی خود را روانه طهران کرده و خودش به تبریز رفته.

Āqā Mostowfi al-Mamālek,[34] may he rest in peace, summoned Pāshā Khān

آقای مستوفی المالک طاب ثراه پاشا خان را

[7v]

to the capital (*dār al-khelāfat*) by order of telegraph. He praised him and bestowed favor upon him, arranging for fifty *tomān*s of spending money to be sent to his residence. He then appointed Mirzā Taqi Khān, the court official, as escort, and the latter accompanied the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān and Bahrām Khān to the blessed presence of his most holy royal majesty [Nāser al-Din Shāh], to whom eternal devotion is owed, by order of Mostowfi al-Mamālek, the highest official of the exalted Iranian state.

با حکم تلگرافی بدار الخلافه احضار کرده. بسیار التفات و مرحمت فرموده پنجاه تمان پول حمّام به منزلش میفرستد. میرزا تقی خان ناظم دفتر را مهماندار میدهد ناظم دفتر بنابر حکم آقای مستوفی المالک شخص اوّل دولت علیّه ایران پاشا خان سرتیپ و بهرام خان را بحضور مبارک اعلیحضرت اقدس شاهنشاهی روحنا و روح العالمین فداه برده.

33 This may refer to Abu'l-Fath Mirzā (d. 1912), a Qajar prince who held several governorships in the late nineteenth century.

34 A title occasionally given in Iranian courts, here referring to Mirzā Yusof Āshtiyāni (1812–86), who served as Nāser al-Din Shāh's grand vizier from 1880 to his death in 1886.

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His holiest majesty, who has our lasting devotion, showed favor to them and spoke many kinds words about them; three months later, when the late commander-in-chief [Moshir al-Dowla] returned to Istanbul with the official permission of the state, the World Sovereign (*qebla-ye ʿālam*) awarded the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān a commander's robe (*sar-dāri-ye amiri*) and the insignia and sash of *sar-tip*. He also bestowed a robe of honor (*khalʿat*) upon Bahrām Khān and granted Avajiq to the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān.

اقدس همایون روحنا فداه التفات و مرحمت کلّی در حقّ انها میفرماید؛ بعد از سه ماه که مرحوم سپه سالار باذن اجازهٔ دولت باسلامبول معاودت کرده، قبلهٔ عالم به پاشا خان سرتیپ یک سرداری امیری و نشان حمایل سرتیپ مرحمت فرموده. به بهرام خان هم خلعت التفات فرموده اواجق را دوباره به پاشا خان سرتیپ مرحمت میفرماید .

Together with the late commander-in-chief [Moshir al-Dowla], he came to Avajiq. Qāzli Gul was in ruins, its subjects having fled in the direction of the Ottomans, Maku, and other areas, when the town had been destroyed by the Jalālis. [Pāshā Khān] sent men and gathered them all and sent his brother Hemmat Khān to Kars to bring four hundred families of the Dāshānlu tribe from there to revive Qāzli Gul and turn it into a town once more. He took control of Crooked Creek (*Egri Chāy*), the location of the Ottoman army camp during the reign of the sultan ʿAbd al-Aziz [*r.* 1861–76] between Qāzli Gul and Abāqiyya and added it to the territory of Qāzli Gul and created settlements around it. After the late Khalifa-Qoli Khān, the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān settled six villages from Ottoman territory besides the towns of Qāzli Gul. The *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān served the court day by day with honesty and integrity

با همراهی سپه سالار مرحوم به اواجق آمده. قازلی گول خراب بوده، همان وقت که جلالی قازلی گول را خراب کرده بود از رعیّت قازلی بطرف عثمانی و ماکو و غیره فرار کرده بودند. آدم فرستاده همه را جمع آور کرده و همت خان برادر خود را بقارص فرستاده بقدر چهارصد خانوار از ایل داشانلو و غیره از قارص آورده قازلی گول را مجدّدا آباد و دائر نموده. اگری چای، که در میان قارلی گول و اباقیه است در سلطنت سلطان عبد العزیز خان جای اوردوی عثمانی بوده، تصرف کرده به خاک قازلی گول مُلحق نموده و آبادان کرده. بعد از مرحوم خلیفه قلیخان، پاشا خان سرتیپ سوای از دهات قازلی گول شش قریه از خاک متصرف عثمانی آباد نموده. پاشا خان سرتیپ روز بروز با صداقت و راستی به دیوان خدمت

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[8r]

و جان نثاری نموده.
در اغتشاش اکراد عباسقلی خان و نجفقلی خان پسران خود را با دویست نفر از آقایان و سواره داو طلب به ارومی فرستاده. مکرر از دیوان حکم صادر شد سوارهٔ اواجق را از جای خود حرکت ندهد، [پاشا خان] جواب داد « اواجق را اینجانب محافظت میکنم. وقت خدمت است، ابًا عنجد خون و گوشت قربان با نان نمک دولت پرورش یافته. در همچون روز در پشت دیوارها باشیم !»

and great devotion.
During the rebellion of the Kurds, ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān and Najaf-Qoli Khān [sons of Pāshā Khān], sent their sons to Urmia with two hundred men from among the *āqā*s and irregular cavalry. The court issued for a second time a decree that the Avajiq horsemen should not move from their location, [to which Pāshā Khān] responded, "I will protect Avajiq. Now is the time to serve; generation after generation, we [*illegible*] have relied on the state for our welfare and prosperity. On a day such as this, let us man the fortresses!"

طوری سرحد را نگهداری و مخافظت کرد عشیرت عثمانی از ماکو بقدر بیست دیر چاپیدند، اما که بحمد، یک بوزقاله از اواجق نتوانستند به برند. خبر آوردند، محمد قابی عبدی با هشتصد سوار و پیاده از اباقیه آمده چالدران را غارت نماید. پاشا خان سرتیپ با باقی سواره اواجق به کومک اهالی چالدران رفته. محمد قابی تیول مرام اسم پاشا خان سرتیپ را شنیده مراجعت و فرار بود. خلاصه عباسقلی خان و نجفقلی خان در همان روز که وارد ارومی شده بودند اکراد به اوردوی تیمور پاشا خان سرتیپ ماکوئی یُرش برده. عباسقلی خان با سواره آیرملو ... خودشان را به

In this way, he preserved and protected the border. The Ottoman tribe plundered twenty villages from Maku, however, thanks be to God, they were not able to steal even one sheep from Avajiq. They brought news of this and Mohammad Qābi ʿAbdi along with eight hundred horsemen from Abāqiyya and foot soldiers came and pillaged Çaldıran. The *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, with the remaining Avajiq horsemen, went to the aid of the people of Çaldıran. When the *toyul* seeker (*toyul-marām*) Mohammad Qābi, heard the name of the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, he retreated and fled. In short, on the very day that ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān and Najaf-Qoli Khān had entered Urmia, the Kurds attacked the encampment of Teymur Pāshā Khān, the *sar-tip* of Maku. ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān along with the Āyromlu horsemen themselves [*illegible*] struck the

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Kurds; the Kurds fired a round of bullets and ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān's horse was hit along with several others. ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān's servant gave him his own horse, he mounted it and killed two Kurdish soldiers with his own hands and cut off their heads. The Kurds were defeated. The people of Urmia, from the nobles to the learned to the commoners, gave witness to these events. On the hill of Hivadi, the evil intentions of the Kurds were, by ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān and the Āyromlu,

اکراد زده؛ اکراد شنلیک تفنگ کرده به اسب عباسقلی خان گلوله خورده با چند نفر دیگر. نُوگر عباسقلی خان اسب خود را بعباسقلیخان داده، سوار شده دو نفر با دست خودش از سرکرده اکراد زده و سرش را بریده. اکراد شکست خورده. اهالی ارومی از اعیان و علما و ادنا باین شهادتی میدهند. پرده پوش نِیَت اکراد را در تپه هیودی عباسقلی خان و سواره آیرملو

[8v]

laid waste.

شکست داد.

However, Teymur Pāshā Khān, who was the head of the army which had long been hostile to the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, took credit publicly for the services of ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān and the Āyromlu and cast doubt upon the services and great efforts of the Āyromlu. But the officials of the Great State invariably recognize the services of the Āyromlu, especially his highness—the most munificent and illustrious Moshir al-Dowla,[35] may his good fortune last, may God, by the veneration of Mohammad and his descendants, grant him longevity. Truly his blessed presence is a great privilege!

آما تیمور پاشا خان که رئیس اوردو بوده که ابًا عنجد با پاشا خان سرتیپ آیرملو عداوت دارند خدمات عباسقلی خان و آیرماو را باسم خود بلند آواز کرده خدمات و زحهات آیرملو را بمرا داد. امّا امنای دولت علیّه همواره خدمات آیرملو را میدانند، علی الخصوص جناب مستطاب اجل اکرم آقای مشیر الدوله دام اقباله، خداوند بحُرمت محمّد و آل محمّد عمر طویل کرامت فرماید. حقیقةً وجود مبارک ایشان غنیمت بزرگ است.

When the late commander-in-chief [Moshir al-Dowla], may he rest in peace, arrived in Urmia, the nobles

در وقتی که سپه سالار مرحوم طاب ثراه وارد ارومی شدند اعیان

35 This was the title (literally, "Pillar of the State") given to Mirzā Hoseyn Khān when he served as grand vizier (*sadr aʿẓam*) from 1871 to 1873, which is likely the period to which the author refers.

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and the learned of that town attested to and corroborated the services of ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān, Najaf-Qoli Khān, and the Āyromlu. The commander-in-chief granted two pieces of insignia, one for *sar-hang* and the other for *yāvar*, to ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān and Najaf-Qoli Khān. Nobody in the *sar-tip* Teymur Pāshā Khān's army, other than the sons of the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, received any state recognition. As for the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān himself, the commander-in-chief committed in Khoy to granting him a higher position and bestowed upon him the sash and insignia of *sar-tip* of the second rank. The commander-in-chief died and [his promises] were left incomplete and unfulfilled.

و علمای ارومی خدمات عباسقلی خان و نجفقلی خان و آیرملو را بپسه سالار مرحوم شهادت و تصدیق کردند. سپه سالار مرحوم دو قطعه نشان یکی سرهنگی و دیگری یاوری بعباسقلی خان و نجفقلی خان مرحمت فرمودند. در اوردوی تیمور پاشا خان سر تیپ بغیر از پسران پاشا خان سر تیپ به احدی امتیاز دولتی داده نشد. بخود پاشا خان سرتیپ سپه سالار در خوی تعهد کردند یکدرجه منصب او را زیاد نمایند و حمایل نشان سر تیپ دویّم مرحمت شود. سپه سالار وفات کرده نا تمام مانده ندادند.

The story of the conditions of the Āyromlu, abridged but in its entirety, has been presented with discernment and prudence. If I were to write in detail, it would become an entire volume! Because the name of the Āyromlu cavalry does not appear in the annals and last year you yourselves had sent a letter [stating], "I have no knowledge of this; write the origins and family stock of all those who have been forgotten and compile them into a booklet [*kitābcha*]." This is why I took the liberty of presenting this work.

احوالات آیرملو را از اوّل تا به آخر بطریق اختصار از روی بصیرت عرض شد. اگر تفصیل میدادم یک جلد کتاب میشد. چونکه اسم سوارهٔ آیرملو در سالنامه نه بود و پارسال خودتان مرقوم فرموده بودید « نا بلد هستم، هر کسی فراموش شده اصل و نسب خود را بنویسد در کتابچه درج شود » از آنجهت جسارت به عرض شد.

Now the descendants of Bodagh Khān who are in Avajiq number one hundred people; eighty are also in Tehran, Yerevan, and Kars. As many as fifty of the *āqā*s of Avajiq have no state salary

الآن اولاد بداغ که در اواجق هستند یکصد نفر است، هشتاد نفر هم در طهران و ایروان و قارص میباشند بقدر پنجاه نفر از اقایان اواجق مواجب دولتی ندارند

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[9r]

and serve without compensation. These days, Avajiq has fallen on extremely hard times and the livelihoods of the *āqās* have sunk into scarcity. The Maku khans enjoy great wealth and they have claimed as property every village which the protectors of the glorious state bestowed as *toyul* or salary of the Āyromlu peoples. These have been seized and, among them they, have taken *toyul*s of Çaldıran and the inhabitants of its towns as their property (*melk-e ʿalāqa*).

بی مواجب خدمت میکنند. الآن اواجق بسیار تنگ شده گذران آقایان به تنگی میگذرد. خاونین ماکو پول زیاد دارند هر دهی را که امنای دولت قاهره به مواجب آیرملوها تیول میدهند ملک علاقه کرده. تصرف میشوند، از آنجمله در تیولات چالدران و سکنی آباد ملک علاقه کرده.

Under the care of the overseer (*sāheb-divān*), it appears that [*five illegible village names*] villages (*toyul*s of the Āyromlu) were erroneously interpreted as part of the Tabriz registry (*daftar*), but in practice they were meant to be in the name of the Āyromlu.[36] Repeatedly, his lofty majesty and the rest of the guardians of the exalted state made decrees by telegraph and other means to offer goods (*tankhʷāh*) as a bribe to try to resolve the problem.

در پیشکاری جناب صاحبدیوان دهات را اشتباهاً در دفتر تبریز از تیولات آیرملو از قرار تفصیل موضوع ... کرده اند، امّا در دستور العمل باسم آیرملوها منظور میشود.* مکررا اعلیحضرت شاهنشاهی و سایر امنای دولت علیّه حکم تلگراف و غیره کرده اند تنخواه رشوت داده رفع رجو کرده اند.

In the conflict between the Ottomans and the Russians, five hundred families of the inhabitants of Bayazit were protected by the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān in Avajiq, in the name of neighborliness and being coreligionists. After the Russian and Ottoman states made

در دعوای عثمانی و روس بقدر پانصد خانه اهالی بایزید را بجهت همجواری و اسلامیّت پاشا خان سرتیپ در اواجق نگه داری کرده. بعد از مصالحه دولتین روس و عثمانی،

*اما چه فایده مباشرین تبریز نمید هند.

Alas, the officials in Tabriz will not grant them to us.

36 (*) Author's note in the margin.

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peace, they returned to their own home [in Bayazit]. They announced and made known the services of the aforementioned [Pāshā Khān] to the Sunni Ottoman state. In his honor, they granted by decree one Ottoman insignia of the third rank. With the consent of the [Iranian] state, he donned the medal.

مراجعت باوطان خودشان نمودند. خدمات معزّ اليه را بدولت سنيّه عثمانی اعلام و معلوم كردند. بافتخار ايشان يک قطعه نشان عالی عثمانی از درجهٔ سيّم با فرمان مرحمت فرمودند. باذن اجازهٔ دولت زيب پيكر نموده.

The khans and *āqā*s of Avajiq are listed below. The official Āyromlu cavalry number two hundred and one individuals but in times of necessity they can number five hundred cavalry and one thousand infantry who serve and devote their lives at the border.

خوانين و آقايان اواجق بقرار تفصيل است. سوارهٔ ديوانی آيرملو جمعی دويست يک نفر است. سواره ديوانی آيرملو دويست يكنفر است امّا در وقت ضرورت پانصد سوار و هزار پياده ميشود كه در سرحد خدمت و جان نثاری ميكنند.

– The favorite of the *khāqān* (*moqarrab al-khāqān*), the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān, commander of the Avajiq frontier, commander of Çaldıran, led by Qā'em Khām Āyromlu. State titles [of Pāshā Khān]: The insignia of *sar-tip* with the sash of that rank; the insignia of first *sar-hang* with the sash of that rank; the Ottoman insignia of the third rank.

– متعبد الخاقان پاشا خان سرتيپ: مامور سرحد اواجق؛ مامور چالدران با سركردگی قايم خان آيرملو؛ مقرّب الخاقان پاشا خان سرتيپ سرحددار. امتيازات دولت : نشان سرتيپ با حمايل آن درجه؛ نشان سرهنگی اوّل با حمايل آن درجه؛ نشان عثمانی از درجه سيّم.

[9v]

– The favorite of the True One (*moqarrab al-haqq*), Hazrat-Qoli Khān;

– مقرب الحق حضرتقلی خان؛

– Rahim Khān, son of the late Khalifa-Qoli Khān;

– رحيم خان پسر خليفه قليخان مرحوم؛

– Rezā Khān, son of Olgā [?];

– رضا خان پسر الگا؛

– Karim Khān, son of Olgā [?];

– كريم خان پسر الگا؛

– Qāsem Khān Āyromlu;

– قاسم خان آيرملو؛

– the *sar-hang* Āqā Khān, son of the *sar-hang* Eskandar Khān;

– آقا خان سرهنگ پسر اسكندر خان سرهنگ؛

– Rostam Khān, son of the late Bodāgh Khān;

– رستم خان پسر بداغ خان مرحوم؛

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– Mohammad Khān, son of the late Bahrām Khān;	– محمد خان پسر بهرام خان مرحوم ؛
– Mohammad-Hasan Khān, son of Hazrat-Qoli Khān;	– محمد حسن خان پسر حضرتقلی خان؛
– Jaʿfar Khān;	– جعفر خان
– Teymur Khān, son of Jaʿfar-Qoli Khān;	– تیمور خان پسر جعفر قلیخان؛
– [*illegible*]-Qoli Khān, son of Bahrām Khān;	– ...قلی خان پسر بهرام خان؛
– Rezā-Qoli Khān, son of Bahrām Khān;	– رضا قلیخان پسر بهرام خان؛
– Mohammad-Taqi Khān, son of Rahim Khān;	– محمد تقی خان پسر رحیم خان؛
– Mohammad-Taqi Khān, son of Rezā Khān;	– محمد تقی خان پسر رضا خان؛
– Asadollāh Khān, son of the *sar-hang* Āqā Khān;	– اسد اله خان پسر آقا خان سر هنگ ؛
– Hasan Āqā, son of Qahramān Khān;	– حسن آقا پسر قهرمان خان؛
– Hāshem Khān, son of Rostam Khān;	– هاشم خان پسر رستم خان؛
– Mohammad-Hasan Khān, brother of Qāsem Khān;	– محمد حسن خان برادر قاسم خان ؛
– [*illegible*] Khān, son of Mohammad Khān;	– ...خان پسر محمد خان؛
– Najaf-Qoli Khān, father of ʿAziz Khān;	– نجفقلی خان ولد عزیز خان؛
– the sons of the *sar-tip* and *sarhad-dār* Pāshā Khān:	– پسران پاشا خان سرتیپ و سرحددار :
– the favorite of the True One (*moqarrab al-haqq*), ʿAbbās-Qoli Khān, the governor of Avajiq (*nāʾeb al-hokuma*);	– مقرب الحق عباسقلی خان نایب الحکومهٔ اواجق؛
– Najaf-Qoli Khān;	– نجفقلیخان ؛
– Mohammad-Qoli Khān;	– محمد قلیخان؛
– Qoli Khān;	– قلیخان؛
– Hasan-Qoli Khān;	– حسنقلی خان؛
– the officer of the Blessed Nāserian Retinue, Qara Khān, great-grandson of the illustrious *sar-tip*, who was named after his ancestors;	– مامور رکاب مبارک ناصری, قره خان نبیرهٔ پسر همان سرتیپ که اسم اجداد خودش گذاشته شده؛

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– the *sar-hang* Haji Khān of the Qazāk [Cossack] Brigade;
– the *sar-hang* Nasrollāh Khān, acting *aide-de-camp* (*yār ājudān*) and assistant to the under-secretary of war (*yāvar-e ma'mur-e khedmat-e vazir-e jang*);
– the *yāvar* Abu'l-Qāsem Khān.

– حاجی خان سرهنگ سوارهٔ قزاق؛
– نصرالله خان سرهنگ و یار آجودان یاور مامور خدمت وزیر جنگ ؛
– ابو القاسم خان یاور.

Once more, a telegraph regarding the salary of the late Bahrām Khān was [sent]. Should I recount it in detail, it would be tedious. However, he [*i.e.*, Bahrām Khān] copied this last telegraph, which wrote, "Note how kind and considerate his most blessed, exalted, royal highness—to whom we owe our eternal devotion—is to the servants of the state. May God take life from the servants and increase the life of his blessed exalted royal highness, who gives due regard to the worth of all of Iran, especially to the Āyromlu tribe, who are the long-established descendants (*khānazādān-e qadim*) of the noble Qajar line."

مکرر تلگراف در باب مواجب مرحوم بهرام خان شده. همه را اگر تفصیل به دهم طول کلام میشود. امّاً صورت تلگراف آخری را نوشته، که « ملاحظه فرماید که اعلیحضرت اقدس همایونی روحنا فداه چه قدر به چاکران دولت رئوف و مهربان است. خداوند از عمر خانه زادان قطع کرده بر عمر اعلیحضرت اقدس شاهنشاهی روحنا فداه افزاید که قدر دان کلّ ایران است، علی الخصوص بر آیل آیرملو که خانه زادان قدیم سلسله جلیله قاجاریه است .»

I hope, God-willing, that this telegraph will be recorded in next year's annals.

امیدوارم انشاالله همین تلگراف را در سالنامهٔ سنهٔ اینده ثبت فرمایند .

Written by the wretched Mohammad, son of the late Bahrām Khān. Offered in sincerity.

کتاب الحقیر محمد ولد بهرام خان مرحوم از روی صداقت عرض کرد.

02 Jumāda I 1304 [26 January 1887]

۰۲ جمادی الاولی سنه ۱۳۴۲

[10r]

Transcription of the telegraph[s] sent regarding the salary of the late Bahrām Khān [exchanged] with his excellency, the most exalted, the most benevolent, pillar of the state, minister of foreign affairs, may his glory

سواد تلگراف که در باب مواجب مرحوم بهرام خان بتوسط جناب مستطاب اجل اکرم مشیر الدوله وزیر امور خارجه دام اجلاله

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endure, to the favorite of the *khāqān* [*i.e.*, Nāser al-Din Shāh], Pāshā Khān, the *sar-tip* and commander of the frontier (*sar-had-dār*):

بمقرب الخاقان پاشا خان سرتیپ و سرحدار کرده ند:

From Khoy, let them deliver quickly to the favorite of the *khāqān*, the *sar-tip* Pāshā Khān.

Pāshā Khān, commander of the frontier of Avajiq, regarding the matter of the salary of the late Bahrām Khān which you have brought up: Najaf-Qoli Khān seized it.[37] These circumstances came to the attention of his imperial presence, to whom we owe our eternal devotion, [and] it was decreed and stated that no-one take the salary of Bahrām Khān. It was taken away from Najaf-Qoli Soltān and confirmed as rightfully belonging to the sons of Bahrām Khān and, in the same way, it was telegraphed to the most exalted and most benevolent one. On this account, be at ease and busy yourself serving in complete tranquility and reassurance (*delgarmi va estezhār*).

Do write with any questions you may have and know that my affection for you is complete.

Moshir al-Dowla

از خوی زود بمقرب الخاقان پاشا خان سرتیپ برسانند.

پاشا خان سرحددار اواجق درباب مواجب مرحوم بهرام خان که اظهار کرده بودید: نجفقلی سلطان برده است. مراتب بعرض حضور همایون روحنا فداه رسید امر و مقرر شد مواجب بهرام خان را احدی نباید ببرد. از نجفقلی سلطان برگشت و در حق پسران بهرام خان برقرار شود و همین طور بجناب اجلّ اکرم تلگراف شد. ازین بابت آسوده بوده و بکمال دلگرمی و استظهار مشغول خدمات بوده.

هر گونه مطالب هم که دارید بنویسید و محبّت مرا دربارهٔ خود کامل بدانید.

مشیر الدوله

37 He should not be confused with the other Najaf-Qoli Khān, son of Pāshā Khān, whom the author portrays in a positive light earlier in the text.

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خدمت جناب جلالت مآب اجلّ عالی امیر نظام زید اجلاله.

پسرهای بهرام خان آیرملو از بابت بعضی از مواجب مرحوم والدشان که بنجفقلی سلطان داده اند عرض تظلّمانه بخاکپای مبارک همایونی روحنا فداه کرده اند. حسب الامر قدر قدر مقرر است خدمت جنابعالی اظهار شود. مواجب خوانین آیرملو سرحد نشین را چرا بکس دیگر میدهند؟ البته باحدی نداده بخودشان بدهند آسوده باشند.

قوام الدوله

For his most glorious majesty, the highest amir of the state, the most lofty and sublime, may his magnificence be ever increased.

The sons of Bahrām Khān Āyromlu, regarding the matter of some of the salary of their deceased father, which had been given to Najaf-Qoli Soltān, put forth a complaint about this injustice to the attention of his most sublime highness of his auspicious majesty, to whom we owe our eternal devotion. According to your most sublime judgment, it was decided that [this matter] be brought to the attention of his highest majesty. Why do they give the salaries of the Āyromlu khans, who live on the frontier, to anyone else? Without giving it to anybody else, [rather], let them have it to themselves, and let them be peaceful.

Qavām al-Dowla[38]

جناب جلالت مآب امیر نظام.

خوانیین آیرملو درباب مواجب بهرام خان که هفتاد یکتمان هر ماه نجفقلی سلطان برده است، تلگرافی کرده بودند. بهرام خان دو پسر دارد—در صورت حقیقةً دو پسر از بهرام خان باقی و حاضرند و راه اطمینان در بودن آنها هست.

For his most glorious majesty, the amir of the state,

The Āyromlu khans had sent a telegraph regarding the salary of Bahrām Khān, [from] which Najaf-Qoli Soltān took seventy-one *tomān*s every month. Bahrām Khān has two sons—in fact, two sons of Bahrām Khān are alive and present, and we can confirm their existence.

38 Mirzā Mohammad-Taqi Āshtiyāni (d. 1873), known as Qavam al-Dowla, served as governor of Azerbaijan and later of Khorasan and Fars in the 1860s and 1870s.

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از نجفقلی سلطان برمیگردد، اسامی پسرهای او را بنویسید در دفتر ثبت بشود.

نایب السلطنه امیر کبیر

[The salary] will be returned from Najaf-Qoli Soltān, write the names of [Bahrām Khān's] sons so that they be recorded in the registry.
Nā'eb al-Saltana [Kāmrān Mirzā] Amir Kabir

جناب جلالتمآب اجلّ اکرم امیر نظام دام اقباله.

پاشا خان سرحددار اواجق و سایر اولاد مرحوم خلیفه قلیخان تلگراف کرده اند که هفتاد یکتمان مواجب ششماه بهرام خان را نجفقلی سلطان برده است. مراتب بعرض حضور همایونی روحنا فراه رسید امر و مقرر شد. فرمودند « مواجب آنها را احدی غیر از اولاد و کسان خودشان نباید ببرد، و آنگهي که خود بهرام خان اولاد هم دارد مواجب بهرام خان از نجفقلی خان بر گردانید در حقّ اولاد بهرام خان برقرار فرمایند. و احدی مطالبه این وجه متعرّض کسان بهرام خان نشوند ». جناب عالی بدیهی است اینطور توجّه فرموده و کسان آنها را هم که در تبریز هستند احضار و اظهار ملاطفت فرموده. از این باب آنها را آسوده خواهد فرمود.

مشیر الدوله

His glorious majesty, the most exalted, most benevolent amir of the state, may his fortune endure,
Pāshā Khān, the commander of the frontier (*sar-dār*) of Avajiq, and the remaining sons of the late Khalifa-Qoli Khān, sent a telegraph [reporting] that Najaf-Qoli Soltān took seventy-one *tomān*s, six months' worth of Bahrām Khān's salary. These circumstances came to the attention of his imperial presence, to whom we owe our lasting devotion, and it was decreed and decided. He ordered: "No-one but sons and relatives must be allowed to take their salary and, given that Bahrām Khān had sons, retake the salary of Bahrām Khān from Najaf-Qoli Soltān so that it be rightfully of the sons of Bahrām Khān. Anyone [else] demanding these wages may not molest the descendants of Bahrām Khān." It is clear that your excellency will [*i.e.*, must] proceed in this manner, and summon their relatives [*i.e.*, of Bahrām Khān] who are in Tabriz and show kindness to them. In this way you will appease and reassure them.
Moshir al-Dowla

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[Transcribed:] 13 Safar 1304 [11 November 1886], corresponding to the original.

۱۳ صفر سنه ۱۳۰۴, سواد مطابق اصل است.

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